

“**Collagen**（胶原蛋白）”是一种能够使皮肤和骨骼更加强健的蛋白质。从成年早期开始，人体产生的胶原蛋白就会逐渐减少。而吸烟和日晒伤害更是会加速这一流失过程。一篇研究综述发现，胶原蛋白片或胶原蛋白粉虽然能改善皮肤、缓解关节疼痛，但它们并非“灵丹妙药”。

Lots of places sell or advertise collagen **supplements**, but what are the benefits of taking them **on a daily basis**? A new scientific review by a team from Anglia Ruskin University, published in the Aesthetic Surgery Journal Open Forum, has looked into exactly this, and here's what it found.

很多地方都销售或宣传胶原蛋白补充剂，但每天服用胶原蛋白究竟有哪些益处？安格利亚鲁斯金大学的一个团队在《美容外科杂志开放论坛》上发表了一项研究，针对这个问题进行了深入探讨，以下是其研究发现。

Let's start with the basics. What is collagen? Well, it's a type of protein found naturally in the body. It supports and strengthens the skin, nails, bone and **connective tissues**. But the amount the body makes drops with age.

首先从最基本的概念说起。胶原蛋白是什么？它是一种天然存在于体内的蛋白质。胶原蛋白支撑并加固皮肤、指甲、骨骼和结缔组织。但其合成速度随着年龄增长而下降。

The team behind this review assessed the results of 113 trials involving nearly 8,000 people, and say it brings together the strongest evidence **to date** on collagen supplements. They say it shows the pills or **powders** can offer some real **skin-rejuvenating** gains. Taken daily, the protein can improve **skin tone** or **elasticity** and **moisture**, but it doesn't appear to prevent other signs of ageing, such as **wrinkles**. The researchers also say supplements can boost collagen levels to ease **joint pain** and **stiffness** from **wear-and-tear arthritis**.

该研究团队评估了涉及 8000 人的 113 个试验结果，并表示这是迄今为止对胶原蛋白补充剂的效果最强有力的证据。研究指出，服用胶原蛋白片或胶原蛋白粉确实能带来一定的“焕肤”功效。坚持每天服用，胶原蛋白可以改善肤色、弹性和水分，但似乎无法预防其它老化痕迹，比如皱纹。研究人员还表示，这些补充剂可以提升胶原蛋白水平，从而缓解由磨损性关节炎导致的关节疼痛与僵硬。

Experts say consumers should be cautious about bold anti-ageing claims and weigh up the potential benefits against the price. And there are several types of supplements people can take, including marine from fish, **bovine** from cows and vegan collagen. The review was unable to show if any worked better than the others.

专家表示，消费者应该警惕夸张的抗衰老宣传，并权衡潜在的益处和价格。目前市面上有多种胶原蛋白补充剂可供选择，包括鱼胶原、牛胶原和纯素胶原蛋白。这篇综述尚无法证实其中哪一种的效果更好。

词汇表

supplements	补充剂
on a daily basis	每天，每日
connective tissues	结缔组织
to date	迄今为止，到目前为止
powders	粉末，散剂
skin-rejuvenating	焕肤的，使肌肤年轻化的
skin tone	肤色，皮肤光泽度
elasticity	弹性
moisture	水分
wrinkles	皱纹
joint pain	关节疼痛
stiffness	僵硬
wear-and-tear arthritis	磨损性关节炎
bovine	牛的

听力练习（答案见下页）

一、听第一遍音频，回答问题。

1. What is the main topic of the report?
 - a. How collagen is produced in the body.
 - b. Research into the benefits of collagen supplements.
 - c. Reviewing different types of anti-ageing products.

二、用一分钟阅读下列问题，然后听第二遍音频并回答问题。

1. The human body cannot make collagen.
 - a. True
 - b. False
 - c. Not given
2. Which word best describes how the researchers feel about the evidence their review brings?
 - a. unsure
 - b. indifferent
 - c. confident
3. The research concludes that collagen supplements must be taken from a young age to have an effect.
 - a. True
 - b. False
 - c. Not given
4. How often should collagen be taken to improve skin tone, elasticity and moisture?
 - a. once a month
 - b. once a week
 - c. every day
5. Which of the following is NOT improved by taking collagen supplements?
 - a. skin elasticity
 - b. wrinkles
 - c. joint pain

三、听第三遍音频，将句子补充完整。（提示：可以反复听，直到听清楚每一个词）

1. The researchers also say supplements can _____ to ease joint pain and stiffness from wear-and-tear arthritis.
2. Experts say consumers should be cautious about bold anti-ageing claims and _____ the potential benefits against the price.

答案

一、听第一遍音频，回答问题。

1. What is the main topic of the report?

b. Research into the benefits of collagen supplements.

二、用一分钟阅读下列问题，然后听第二遍音频并回答问题。

1. **b. False.** *What is collagen? Well, it's a type of protein **found naturally in the body.***

2. **c. The team behind this review** *assessed the results of 113 trials involving nearly 8,000 people, and **say it brings together the strongest evidence to date** on collagen supplements.*

3. **c. Not given.** The report makes no mention of when someone should start taking collagen supplements.

4. **c. Taken daily,** *the protein can improve skin tone or elasticity and moisture...*

5. **b. Taken daily,** *the protein can improve skin tone or elasticity and moisture, **but it doesn't appear to prevent other signs of ageing, such as wrinkles.***

三、听第三遍音频，将句子补充完整。（提示：可以反复听，直到听清楚每一个词）

1. The researchers also say supplements can **boost collagen levels** to ease joint pain and stiffness from wear-and-tear arthritis.

2. Experts say consumers should be cautious about bold anti-ageing claims and **weigh up** the potential benefits against the price.